DANG-Med: Dual-Stream Attention-Augmented Network with Prototype-Anchored Spatial Support and Gated Directional Strip Alignment for Multi-Center Polyp Segmentation

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October 18, 2026

Abstract

Deep convolutional and vision transformer networks have achieved strong in-domain accuracy on curated colonoscopy benchmarks such as Kvasir-SEG ($\sim$ 93% mDice), yet their segmentation reliability degrades under real-world clinical stress conditions: (i) severe label scarcity when adapting to new clinical centers (5%–10% labeled frames), (ii) natural tiny ($< 1.5\%$ mucosal area) and flat low-contrast camouflaged polyps across unseen imaging systems (e.g., ETIS-LaribPolypDB), and (iii) adverse endoscopic acquisition shifts including Narrow-Band Imaging (NBI) spectral emphasis, distal-lumen low-light falloff, and wet mucosal specular glare with motion defocus. To address these clinical failure modes on a single GPU, we propose **DANG-Med** (*Dual-Stream Attention-Augmented Network with Prototype-Anchored Spatial Support and Gated Directional Strip Alignment*), a hybrid architecture coupling a local multi-scale ConvNeXt-Tiny hierarchy with a frozen DINOv2-Base foundation backbone (85.95M frozen parameters) adapted via Frequency-Routed Mixture-of-Experts Convolutional LoRA (**Freq-MoE Conv-LoRA**). DANG-Med introduces four architectural pillars: (1) a **4-Scale Learned DPT Multi-Layer Reassembler** with a **Dual-Prototype and Image-Adaptive Self-Support Margin Head** that separates polyp versus mucosa token manifolds under 40-image few-shot supervision; (2) a **Prototype-Anchored Spatial Support Envelope (PASSE)** that suppresses isolated far-field false-positive background specks while reinforcing diminutive lesion cores; (3) a **Multi-Scale Homomorphic Retinex Chromatic Stem** paired with a **DINOv2-Conditioned Low-Frequency Style Calibrator**; and (4) an **Uncertainty-Guided Reverse-Attention Directional Strip Decoder** (**FastAxialStripSSM**) modulated by normalized Bernoulli boundary variance $4p(1-p)$. We evaluate two distinct protocols across deduplicated in-domain, multi-center out-of-distribution (PolypGen 6-center dev/extended, CVC-ClinicDB, CVC-ColonDB, CVC-300, ETIS-LaribPolypDB), and synthetic adverse stress cohorts: (A) our primary **Round 9/10 zero-shot stem protocol** (5% few-shot, $n = 40$), where all models share the same primary segmentation objective and no adverse synthetic corruptions are used during training; and (B) our **Round 8 adverse-trained stem protocol** (10% few-shot, $n = 80$). Under the Round 9 Seed 42 benchmark, **DANG-Med v4.1 (`R9e`)** improves over the single-stream ConvNeXt-Tiny+FPN baseline (`R9a`) by +10.79 **pp (**+27.68% **relative) mDice**, +12.88 **pp (**+42.20% **relative) mIoU**, +22.68 **pp (**+234.38% **relative) Boundary F1**, and −26.85% **HD95 error** on few-shot tiny/camouflaged lesions ($S_1 \times S_2$, $n = 310$), and by +11.86 **pp (**+19.70% **relative) mDice**, +29.93% **relative mIoU**, +121.76% **relative Boundary F1**, and −43.88% **HD95 error** on few-shot external generalization ($S_1 \rightarrow$ PraNet-Ext, $n = 696$). On full-data training ($n = 800$), zero-shot **DANG-Med v4.1 (`R9e`)** reaches 80.78% **mDice on ETIS-LaribPolypDB** (+6.22 pp over shared-loss `R9a`, −16.77% HD95), while adverse-trained **DANG-Med v4 (`R8e`)** reaches 81.53% **mDice on ETIS-LaribPolypDB** (+13.92 pp / +20.58% relative over standard baseline `R8a`) and 73.87% **mDice on Adverse Endoscopy (S_3, $n = 272$)**. Multi-seed evaluation ('R10a'–'R10e', Seeds 42–46) confirms consistent gains and substantially reduced cross-seed variance.

1 Introduction

Colorectal cancer (CRC) remains one of the leading causes of cancer-related mortality worldwide, and early endoscopic detection and resection of adenomatous and sessile serrated polyps during optical colonoscopy significantly reduces CRC incidence (Jha et al., 2020; Ali et al., 2023). Automated pixel-level polyp segmentation provides computer-aided delineation (CADe/CADx) of lesion margins during withdrawal. However, a substantial gap persists between in-domain benchmark saturation and multi-center clinical deployment. On standard in-domain white-light colonoscopy splits such as Kvasir-SEG (Jha et al., 2020), modern hierarchical convolutional networks (e.g.,

ConvNeXt-Tiny (Liu et al., 2022) with Feature Pyramid Networks (Lin et al., 2017)) already achieve 92.5%–93.1% mean Dice (mDice). Under such saturated in-domain conditions, architectural modifications yield modest differences (< 0.5–1.0 percentage points), obscuring whether a proposed model genuinely improves out-of-distribution (OOD) robustness.

In clinical practice, endoscopic segmentation systems degrade across three compounding stress axes:

1. **Label-Scarce Multi-Center Adaptation (S_1):** Annotating pixel-accurate polyp contours requires expert gastroenterologists. When training under a strict 5%–10% annotation budget (40–80 labeled images), standard CNNs overfit to source-hospital background textures and suffer severe boundary degradation on external centers (Boundary F1 $< 20\%$, HD95 > 80 px).

2. **Natural Tiny and Low-Contrast Camouflaged Lesions (S_2):** Flat Paris 0-IIa/IIb adenomas and diminutive polyps occupying $< 1.5\%$ of the endoscopic field of view (FOV) or exhibiting low RGB contrast (< 0.085) against surrounding vascular mucosa are frequently missed (elevated empty-prediction rates) or fragmented by stride-16/32 feature pooling, particularly on external cohorts such as ETIS-LaribPolypDB (Silva et al., 2014) and CVC-ColonDB (Tajbakhsh et al., 2015).

3. **Adverse Endoscopic Acquisition Shifts (S_3):** Endoscopic procedures frequently switch between White-Light Imaging (WLI) and Narrow-Band Imaging (NBI)-like spectral shifts, encounter distal-lumen illumination falloff ($\gamma > 2.2$ with sensor noise), and suffer from wet mucosal specular highlights coupled with motion/defocus blur.

While Vision Foundation Models (VFMs) such as DINOv2 (Oquab et al., 2024) and SAM (Kirillov et al., 2023) offer strong semantic invariance across domains, their coarse patch grids (14×14 stride) lack fine subpixel boundary localization. Conversely, naive feature concatenation between a CNN encoder and a ViT backbone can degrade high-resolution CNN edge features when ViT patch tokens are bilinearly upsampled across lesion boundaries, and sequential 2D state-space scans (SS2D (Liu et al., 2024)) incur substantial Python/CUDA kernel launch overhead on multi-scale feature pyramids.

In this work, we present **DANG-Med**, illustrated in Figure 1. Our main contributions are:

- **Auditable Multi-Center Deduplication Hygiene and Clinical Stress Evaluation:** We implement an automated perceptual-hash and MD5 deduplication pipeline (`HYGIENE_MANIFEST_JSON`) across Kvasir-SEG, 6-center PolypGen (Ali et al., 2023) (Dev $n = 258$ and Extended $n = 974$ in Round 9/10; $n = 272$ and $n = 967$ in Round 8), all 4 official PraNet external benchmarks (Fan et al., 2020) ($n = 696$ after removing 2 exact/FOV duplicates against Kvasir: CVC-300 $n = 60$, CVC-ClinicDB $n = 61$, CVC-ColonDB $n = 379$, ETIS-LaribPolypDB $n = 196$), and derived stress tracks (S_1 5%/10% few-shot, S_2 pooled tiny/camouflaged lesions $n = 310/315$, and S_3 synthetic adverse acquisitions $n = 258/272$).

- **4-Scale DPT Reassembly, Dual-Prototype Self-Support, and PASSE Envelope:** We project multi-depth DINOv2 tokens into an L_2-normalized prototype hypersphere combining orthogonally initialized K-prototype cosine margins, training-gated ground-truth EMA support anchors, and test-time image-adaptive self-support centroids. Crucially, we introduce the **Prototype-Anchored Spatial Support Envelope (PASSE)**, which forms a dilated semantic support envelope to suppress far-field false-positive background specks (reducing HD95) while reinforcing low-contrast tiny polyp cores.

- **Retinex Chromatic Stem and DINO-Conditioned Style Calibration:** We design a differentiable homomorphic Retinex stem (`RetinexChromaticStem`) that performs specular highlight inpainting and multi-scale illumination division gated by an anomaly detector against source white-light EMA statistics (evaluated both without adverse-corruption training in Round 9/10 and with online endoscopic shift synthesis in Round 8), complemented by DINOv2-conditioned low-frequency style calibration at strides 4 and 8.

- **Directional Strip Alignment and Uncertainty-Guided Reverse-Attention Decoder:** We formulate **FastAxialStripSSM** using fused cuDNN horizontal ($1\times11, 7\times1$), vertical ($11\times1, 1\times7$), and dilated ($3 \times 3, d = 3$) depthwise strip operators modulated by normalized Bernoulli boundary variance $u = 4p(1-p)$ and outer morphological ring halos.

2 Related Work

2.1 Polyp Segmentation and Boundary-Aware Decoders

Deep polyp segmentation architectures have progressed from U-Net (Ronneberger et al., 2015) and UNet++ (Zhou et al., 2018) to reverse-attention and boundary-aware networks. PraNet (Fan et al., 2020) introduced parallel partial decoders and iterative reverse attention to mine boundary cues from Res2Net backbones. CaraNet (Lou et al., 2022) extended reverse attention with axial context and channel-wise feature pyramid modules for small medical objects. Subsequent Transformer-based architectures such as Polyp-PVT (Dong et al., 2021) and TransFuse (Zhang et al., 2021) paired or replaced CNN encoders with Pyramid Vision Transformers to improve multi-center generalization on CVC-ColonDB and ETIS-LaribPolypDB. Unlike

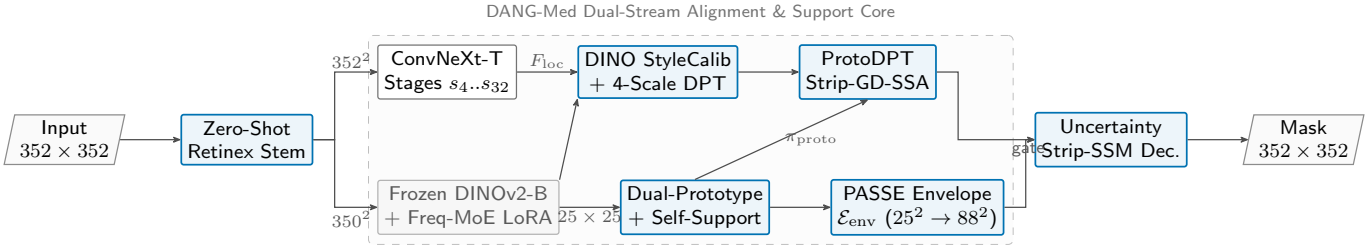


Figure 1: **Overview of the proposed DANG-Med architecture.** An input endoscopic frame (352 × 352) passes through the Multi-Scale Homomorphic Retinex Chromatic Stem (`RetinexChromaticStem`) to suppress specular highlights and standardize illumination/chrominance against source white-light EMA statistics. The local stream (ConvNeXt-Tiny stages $s_4..s_{32}$) captures sharp mucosal edges while the semantic stream (frozen DINOv2-Base with Freq-MoE Conv-LoRA on blocks 8..11) extracts multi-depth 25 × 25 patch tokens from layers $\{2, 5, 8, 11\}$. Our highlighted contributions (blue) include DINO-Conditioned Low-Frequency Style Calibration, 4-Scale Learned DPT Reassembly, the Dual-Prototype & Self-Support Margin Head, the Prototype-Anchored Spatial Support Envelope (PASSE), and the Uncertainty-Guided Reverse-Attention Directional Strip Decoder.

dual-branch models that fuse features only at coarse 1/16 and 1/32 scales with unconstrained bilinear upsampling, DANG-Med performs 4-scale learned DPT depth mixing with content-aware edge-snapped upsampling and explicit spatial support gating at stride 4 (88 × 88).

2.2 Vision Foundation Models and Parameter-Efficient Adaptation

Self-supervised Vision Transformers pretrained via discriminative self-distillation, notably DINOv2 (Oquab et al., 2024), exhibit strong part-level semantic consistency across domains, while promptable foundation models such as SAM (Kirillov et al., 2023) and its medical adaptations require either bounding-box prompts or heavy decoder fine-tuning. Adapting VFMs to autonomous dense medical segmentation while preventing overfitting on small clinical datasets ($N \leq 800$) benefits from parameter-efficient fine-tuning (PEFT) such as LoRA (Hu et al., 2022) and Dense Prediction Transformers (DPT) (Ranftl et al., 2021). We freeze 100% of the DINOv2-Base backbone (85.95M parameters; 86.58M total frozen buffers) and inject lightweight Frequency-Routed Mixture-of-Experts Convolutional LoRA (**Freq-MoE Conv-LoRA**) adapters into blocks 8–11, decomposing spatial tokens into low-frequency context and high-frequency edge energy routed across dilation rates $d \in \{1, 2, 3\}$.

2.3 State-Space and Directional Strip Operators in Medical Vision

Structured State-Space Sequence Models (S4, Mamba (Gu and Dao, 2023)) and 2D visual extensions (VMamba (Liu et al., 2024), U-Mamba (Ma et al., 2024)) model long-range spatial dependencies. However, executing recursive 4-directional 1D scans in Python across multi-scale 2D feature pyramids incurs substantial kernel launch overhead. Motivated by the connection between truncated state-space convolutional kernels and directional strip convolutions, our **FastAxialStripSSM** captures horizontal, vertical, and dilated contextual dependencies using fused depthwise strip convolutions gated by cross-stream conditioning, achieving 17.4–20.0 FPS (batch size 4, 352 × 352, FP16 on NVIDIA T4).

3 Methodology: The DANG-Med Architecture

Given an input endoscopic RGB image $I \in \mathbb{R}^{B\times3\times H\times W}$ ($H = W = 352$), DANG-Med (`src/dang/model.py`) predicts a dense foreground polyp probability map $\hat{Y} = \sigma(Z) \in [0, 1]^{B\times1\times H\times W}$. Figure 1 illustrates the complete pipeline.

3.1 Retinex Chromatic Stem and DINO-Conditioned Style Calibrator

Endoscopic frames from external centers or adverse modes exhibit non-uniform illumination and spectral shifts. Let $X_{\text{rgb}} \in [0, 1]^{B\times3\times H\times W}$ denote the unnormalized RGB image entering `RetinexChromaticStem`.

1) Specular Highlight Inpainting: Mucosal glare saturates all three RGB channels. We detect specular pixels via a smooth minimum-channel gate $w_{\text{glare}} = \sigma(18.0 \cdot (\min_c X_{\text{rgb}} - 0.82))$ and blend them with a 15 × 15 local average filter $\bar{X}_{15}$:

$$X_{\text{deg}} = (1 - w_{\text{glare}})X_{\text{rgb}} + w_{\text{glare}}\bar{X}_{15}. \quad (1)$$

2) Multi-Scale Homomorphic Retinex Division: Approximating image intensity as the product of illumination $L(x)$ and mucosal reflectance $R(x)$, we estimate illumination envelopes $L_{31} = \text{AvgPool}_{31\times31}(X_{\text{deg}}) + \epsilon$ and $L_{15} = \text{AvgPool}_{15\times15}(X_{\text{deg}}) + \epsilon$ ($\epsilon = 0.03$) and recover log-reflectance:

$$\tilde{R} = \log(X_{\text{deg}} + \epsilon) - \big(0.65 \log L_{31} + 0.35 \log L_{15}\big). \quad (2)$$

3) Source EMA Standardization and Anomaly Gate: During training on source Kvasir-SEG images, the stem updates exponential moving average reference buffers $(\mu_{\text{ref}}, \sigma_{\text{ref}}) \in \mathbb{R}^{1\times3\times1\times1}$ (in training mode only; frozen during `model.eval()`). In our Round 9/10 protocol ('R9d', 'R9e', 'R10d', 'R10e'), 'aug_prob' inside the stem is hard-set to 0.0 so no synthetic adverse corruptions are generated during training (source-trained with standard photometric jitter, evaluated on unseen S_3 synthetic corruptions). In our Round 8 protocol ('R8d', 'R8e'), online endoscopic shift synthesis is enabled during training for comparison. Combining instance-standardized reflectance $\hat{R}$ and global chromaticity $\hat{X}_{\text{deg}}$, the restored image is $X_{\text{rest}} = \text{clip}((0.55\hat{X}_{\text{deg}} + 0.45\hat{R})\sigma_{\text{ref}} + \mu_{\text{ref}}, 0, 1)$. A photometric anomaly score A_{phot} measures the normalized deviation of $(\mu(X_{\text{deg}}), \sigma(X_{\text{deg}}))$ from $(\mu_{\text{ref}}, \sigma_{\text{ref}})$ plus glare fraction, gating a learned 3×3 residual refinement branch (with minimum blend floor 0.04).

At high-resolution ConvNeXt stages s_4 (88×88) and s_8 (44×44), **DINOFreqStyleCalibrator** decomposes local CNN features F_{loc} into a 9×9 low-frequency component F_{low} and high-frequency detail $F_{\text{high}} = F_{\text{loc}} - F_{\text{low}}$, modulating both via affine parameters $(\gamma_{\text{low}}, \beta_{\text{low}}, \gamma_{\text{high}})$ predicted from the global DINOv2 context vector $g_{\text{dino}} \in \mathbb{R}^{B\times768}$.

3.2 4-Scale DPT Reassembly and Dual-Prototype Self-Support Margin Head

We extract spatial token grids $\{T_\ell\}_{\ell\in\{2,5,8,11\}} \subset \mathbb{R}^{B\times768\times25\times25}$ from DINOv2-Base (with Freq-MoE Conv-LoRA of rank $r = 4$ on blocks 8–11) and project each to $D = 192$ channels: $S_\ell = \text{ConvBNAct}_{1\times1}(T_\ell)$.

4-Scale Learned DPT Reassembler: We learn a 4×4 depth-mixing matrix $W = \text{Softmax}(\Theta) \in \mathbb{R}^{4\times4}$ across scales $s \in \{0,1,2,3\}$:

$$\tilde{S}_s = \sum_{\ell=0}^{3} W_{s,\ell} S_\ell, \quad \hat{S}_s = \phi_s\big(\text{Up}_s(\tilde{S}_s, F_{\text{loc}}^{(s)})\big), \tag{3}$$

where scales s_8 and s_{16} use content-aware **Edge-Snapped Semantic Upsampling** (predicting 3×3 local reassembly kernels from CNN features $F_{\text{loc}}^{(s)}$, initialized to bilinear interpolation).

Dual-Prototype and Self-Support Margin Head: We concatenate $[S_1, S_2, S_3]$, project to $D_p = 128$ dimensions, and L_2-normalize across channels to obtain unit token embeddings $\hat{Z} \in \mathbb{R}^{B\times D_p\times25\times25}$. We initialize $K = 8$ learnable foreground prototypes $\{p_k^+\}_{k=1}^K$ and $K = 8$ background prototypes $\{p_k^-\}_{k=1}^K$ orthogonally, alongside training-gated ground-truth EMA support anchors (a^+, a^-) updated only during training from downsampled mask occupancy ($M_{25} \geq 0.35$ for foreground, $M_{25} \leq 0.10$ for background). The prior cosine margin logit at each 25×25 patch (u, v) is:

$$\pi_{\text{prior}}(u,v) = \tau\Big(\frac{1}{\beta}\log\sum_{k=1}^{K} e^{\beta\langle\hat{Z}_{u,v},\hat{p}_k^+\rangle} - \frac{1}{\beta}\log\sum_{k=1}^{K} e^{\beta\langle\hat{Z}_{u,v},\hat{p}_k^-\rangle}\Big) + w_{\text{ema}}\cdot10\big(\langle\hat{Z}_{u,v}, a^+\rangle - \langle\hat{Z}_{u,v}, a^-\rangle\big) + b. \tag{4}$$

During inference (without ground-truth masks), we compute image-specific self-support centroids $c^+ = \text{Norm}(\sum_{u,v} p_{u,v}^2 \hat{Z}_{u,v})$ and $c^- = \text{Norm}(\sum_{u,v}(1-p_{u,v})^2\hat{Z}_{u,v})$ where $p_{u,v} = \sigma(\pi_{\text{prior}}(u,v))$, yielding the 25×25 prototype margin map:

$$\pi_{\text{proto}}(u,v) = \pi_{\text{prior}}(u,v) + 8w_{\text{ss}}\big(\langle\hat{Z}_{u,v}, c^+\rangle - \langle\hat{Z}_{u,v}, c^-\rangle\big). \tag{5}$$

3.3 Prototype-Anchored Spatial Support Envelope (PASSE)

Recall-enhancing prototype priors reduce missed polyps (empty predictions) on diminutive and adverse images, but can allow isolated high-frequency CNN texture noise far from the true polyp to cross the 0.5 threshold, inflating HD95. To resolve this trade-off, **PASSE** constructs a 25×25 semantic probability map $P_{\text{sem}} = \sigma(0.5M_4^{\uparrow25} + 0.5\pi_{\text{proto}})$ from the coarsest decoder stage logit M_4 and prototype logit π_{proto} (falling back to $P_{\text{sem}} = \sigma(M_4^{\uparrow25})$ when the prototype head is disabled, as in variant `R9d`), and computes a dilated smooth support envelope:

$$\mathcal{E}_{\text{env}} = \text{AvgPool}_{3\times3}\big(\text{MaxPool}_{5\times5}(P_{\text{sem}})\big) \in [0,1]^{B\times1\times25\times25}. \tag{6}$$

Upsampling $\mathcal{E}_{\text{env}}$ and P_{sem} to stride 4 (88×88), PASSE modulates the stride-4 decoder logit Z_{88} via two spatial terms:

$$Z_{88}^{\text{PASSE}} = Z_{88} - 2.2\,\frac{\text{ReLU}(0.22 - \mathcal{E}_{\text{env}}^{\uparrow88})}{0.22} + 1.2\,\text{ReLU}(P_{\text{sem}}^{\uparrow88} - 0.38). \tag{7}$$

3.4 Uncertainty-Guided Directional Strip Decoder

At each pyramid scale $s \in \{s_8, s_{16}, s_{32}\}$, **GDSSAFusion** aligns local CNN features $F_{\text{loc}}^{(s)}$ and semantic features $\hat{S}_s$ using **FastAxialStripSSM**, a gated finite-kernel directional strip operator:

$$\text{StripSSM}(U, C) = U + g_h \odot \mathcal{K}_{7\times1}(\mathcal{K}_{1\times11}(U)) + g_v \odot \mathcal{K}_{1\times7}(\mathcal{K}_{11\times1}(U)) + g_d \odot \mathcal{K}_{3\times3,d=3}(U), \tag{8}$$

where $(g_h, g_v, g_d) = \sigma(\text{Conv}_{1\times1}([U, C]))$ are input-conditioned directional gates and $\mathcal{K}$ denotes depthwise strip convolutions. In the top-down decoder ($P_4 \to P_3 \to P_2 \to P_1$), each **UncertaintyStripDecoderStage** computes from the coarser stage's logit $M_{s+1}^{\uparrow}$ three spatial priors: (i) foreground probability $A_{\text{fg}} = \sigma(M_{s+1}^{\uparrow})$, (ii)

normalized Bernoulli boundary variance $U_s = 4A_{\text{fg}}(1 - A_{\text{fg}}) \in [0, 1]$ which peaks at 1.0 along ambiguous borders ($A_{\text{fg}} = 0.5$), and (iii) an outer morphological ring halo $R_s = \text{clip}(\text{MaxPool}_{5\times5}(A_{\text{fg}}) - A_{\text{fg}}, 0, 1)$, followed by A2BD Sobel-L_1 edge refinement.

3.5 Training Objective and Variant Configuration Matrix

In Round 9 and Round 10 ('R9a'–'R9e', 'R10a'–'R10e'), all arms use the exact same loss implementation `compute_total_loss` (`src/dang/train.py`, lines 103–140):

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{total}} = \mathcal{L}^{\tilde{w}}_{\text{BCE+Dice}}(Z, Y) + 0.25\,\mathcal{L}^{\tilde{w},\alpha(a)}_{\text{Tversky}}(Z, Y) + 0.10\,\mathcal{L}_{\text{far}}(Z, Y) + 0.25\sum_{j=2}^{4}\frac{1}{3}\mathcal{L}^{\tilde{w}}_{\text{BCE+Dice}}(M_j, Y) + 0.35\,\mathbb{I}[\text{proto}]\,\mathcal{L}_{\text{proto}}(\pi_{\text{proto}}, Y_{25}), \tag{9}$$

where $a = 100 \cdot \bar{Y}$ is the ground-truth lesion area percentage, $w_i = \text{clip}((3.0/(a_i + 0.35))^{0.40}, 1.0, 2.4)$ is normalized per batch via $\tilde{w}_i = w_i/\bar{w}$, $\alpha_{\text{fp}}(a) = 0.45 + 0.15\sigma((a - 1.5)/0.5)$ and $\beta_{\text{fn}}(a) = 1 - \alpha_{\text{fp}}(a)$ adapt Tversky supervision by lesion area, and $\mathcal{L}_{\text{far}}(Z, Y)$ averages $\sigma(Z_x)(1 - \text{Dilate}_r(Y)_x)$ across four dilation radii $r \in \{4, 8, 14, 20\}$ px to penalize far-field false positives across all five arms. The auxiliary prototype supervision term $0.35\,\mathcal{L}_{\text{proto}}$ (applying $\mathcal{L}^{\tilde{w}}_{\text{BCE+Dice}} + 0.25\mathcal{L}^{\tilde{w},\alpha(a)}_{\text{Tversky}}$ to π_{proto} vs. Y_{25}) is active whenever the architecture includes the prototype head ($\mathbb{I}[\text{proto}] = 1$ in `R9c`, `R9e`, `R8c`, `R8e`; $\mathbb{I}[\text{proto}] = 0$ in `R9a`, `R9b`, `R9d`, `R8a`, `R8b`, `R8d`). Specifically, the five Round 9 arms are configured as follows:

- `R9a` **(Single-Stream Baseline, run `f328e771`, commit `e1379f6`):** ConvNeXt-Tiny + FPN decoder (30.96M trainable / 30.96M total params), trained with Eq. (9) ($\mathbb{I}[\text{proto}] = 0$).
- `R9b` **(Dual-Stream SafeConcat Control, run `e770b25c`, commit `946256c`):** ConvNeXt-Tiny + frozen DINOv2-Base with Freq-MoE Conv-LoRA + SafeConcat fusion + FPN decoder (33.57M trainable / 120.15M total params, $\mathbb{I}[\text{proto}] = 0$).
- `R9c` **(DANG-v4.1 ProtoDPT + PASSE + UncStrip, No Stem, run `f676224f`, commit `1218ebb`):** Enables `use_proto_dpt=true`, `use_passe_envelope=true`, `fusion_mode=safe_gd_ssa_v2`, `decoder_mode=uncertainty_strip_ssm`, `use_retinex_stem=false`, `use_style_calib=false` (42.80M trainable / 129.38M total params, $\mathbb{I}[\text{proto}] = 1$).
- `R9d` **(DANG-v4.1 RetinexStem + StyleCalib + PASSE + UncStrip, No ProtoDPT, run `5356b752`, commit `6d252bb`):** Enables `use_retinex_stem=true` (zero-shot, `aug_prob=0`), `use_style_calib=true`, `use_passe_envelope=true`, `fusion_mode=safe_gd_ssa_v2`, `decoder_mode=uncertainty_strip_ssm`, `use_proto_dpt=false` (39.78M trainable / 126.36M total params, $\mathbb{I}[\text{proto}] = 0$).
- `R9e` **(DANG-Med v4.1 Flagship, run `db1786be`, commit `a06b349`):** Enables all pillars simultaneously: `use_retinex_stem=true` (`aug_prob=0`), `use_style_calib=true`, `use_proto_dpt=true`, `use_passe_envelope=true`, `fusion_mode=safe_gd_ssa_v2`, `decoder_mode=uncertainty_strip_ssm` (43.32M trainable / 129.90M total params, $\mathbb{I}[\text{proto}] = 1$).

In Round 8 (`R8a` run `4ff780b9`, `R8b` run `eed6d338`, `R8c` run `02df9e4a`, `R8d` run `d47b9a4b`, `R8e` run `a8ecd157`), `R8a` and `R8b` used standard unweighted BCE+Dice+Tversky without $\mathcal{L}_{\text{far}}$ or PASSE, whereas `R8d` and `R8e` enabled online adverse corruption synthesis during stem training. Comparing `R8` and `R9` therefore disentangles shared primary loss effects (`R8a` → `R9a`), architectural + prototype-anchored support effects under zero-shot corruptions (`R9a` → `R9e`), and online adverse stem training effects (`R9e` → `R8e`).

4 Experimental Setup and Data Hygiene

4.1 Datasets, Deduplication Hygiene, and Evaluation Cohorts

Public composite polyp repositories (e.g., `combo_polyp` / PolypGen) contain UUID-named Kvasir-SEG images in their raw splits and occasional near-duplicate frames. We enforce an automated deduplication pipeline (`src/dang/data.py`, logged via `HYGIENE_MANIFEST_JSON`):

1. **In-Domain Kvasir-SEG ($n = 1{,}000$ raw):** Shuffled (`seed=20260101`) into **Train-Full ($n = 800$)**, **Train-S_1 Few-Shot (5%, $n = 40$ in R9/R10; 10%, $n = 80$ in R8)**, **Val ($n = 95$)**, and **ID-Test ($n = 90$)**, where any validation or test image with 64-bit perceptual difference hash distance $\text{dHash}_{64} \leq 4$ to any training image is dropped (5 in Val, 10 in ID-Test).
2. **PolypGen 6-Center Out-of-Distribution (`C1`–`C6`) (Ali et al., 2023):** Kvasir UUID filenames (204 in Dev, 796 in Extended), empty masks (30 in Dev, 86 in Extended), exact MD5 duplicates, and frames with $\min_{x \in \text{Kvasir}} \text{dHash}_{64} \leq 4$ (14 in Dev, 78 in Extended) are removed, yielding **PolypGen-Dev ($n = 258$ in R9/R10; $n = 272$ in R8 prior to the $\text{dHash}_{64} \leq 4$ filter)** and **PolypGen-Extended Holdout ($n = 974$ in R9/R10 after also filtering 47 Dev near-duplicates and 49 intra-Extended near-duplicates; $n = 967$ in R8)**. We note that 74 frames in PolypGen-Extended share `C4` video sequence prefixes with Dev; we therefore also track sequence-disjoint subsets in our logs.

3. **PraNet Official External Benchmarks ($n = 696$ total across 4 datasets) (Fan et al., 2020):** After removing 2 frames with exact/FOV-cropped $\text{dHash}_{64} \leq 1$ overlap against Kvasir-SEG (1 in CVC-ClinicDB, 1 in CVC-ColonDB), we evaluate: **CVC-300 ($n = 60$)**, **CVC-ClinicDB ($n = 61$)**, **CVC-ColonDB ($n = 379$)**, and **ETIS-LaribPolypDB ($n = 196$)**.

4. **Derived Clinical Stress Track S_2 (Natural Tiny & Camouflaged Polyps, $n = 310$ in R9/R10; $n = 315$ in R8):** Pooled across PolypGen-Dev, ETIS-LaribPolypDB, and CVC-ColonDB for natural lesions with area $< 1.5\%$ of FOV (`S2_Tiny_LT1.5pct`, $n = 188$) or area $< 3.0\%$ with local boundary RGB contrast < 0.085 (`S2_Camouflaged_LowContrast`, $n = 122$). Because S_2 and S_3 are derived from the external cohorts above to isolate specific clinical failure modes, they are diagnostic stress slices rather than statistically independent patient cohorts.

5. **Derived Clinical Stress Track S_3 (Synthetic Adverse Endoscopy, $n = 258$ in R9/R10; $n = 272$ in R8):** Deterministic transformations of PolypGen-Dev frames across 4 regimes: `Adverse_NBI_Spectral`, `Adverse_LowLight_Lumen` ($\gamma = 2.55$ + vignette + shot noise), `Adverse_Specular_Glare_Blur`, and `Adverse_Combined_Severe`.

4.2 Implementation Details and Evaluation Metrics

All models are trained at 352×352 resolution ($350 \times 350 = 25 \times 25$ patches for DINOv2-Base) with batch size 16, AdamW ($\text{lr}_{\text{cnn}} = 1.6 \times 10^{-4}$, $\text{lr}_{\text{new}} = 4.0 \times 10^{-4}$, $\text{lr}_{\text{peft}} = 1.0 \times 10^{-3}$; weight decay 10^{-4} on CNN/head parameters and 0.0 on PEFT/bias/normalization parameters), cosine annealing with warmup, EMA decay 0.992, and FP16 mixed precision on NVIDIA T4 GPUs. Track S_1 trains for 40 epochs (~ 3.4 s/epoch on `R9a`, ~ 11.8 s/epoch on `R9e`), and Track Full trains for 20 epochs (~ 20.4 s/epoch on `R9a`, $\sim$ 72–80 s/epoch on `R9e`). Checkpoint selection uses Kvasir-Val mDice exclusively (`model.eval()` never receives ground-truth masks).

At 352×352 resolution with threshold 0.5 (`src/dang/metrics.py`), we report **mDice (%)**, **mIoU (%)**, **Boundary F1 (%)** (1-px morphological contour with 2-px dilation tolerance), and **95th-percentile Hausdorff Distance (HD95, px)**. When a prediction mask is empty while the ground-truth mask is non-empty (or vice versa), BF1 = 0 and our implementation assigns a fixed finite quarter-diagonal penalty $\text{HD95}_{\text{empty}} = 0.25\sqrt{352^2 + 352^2} \approx 124.45$ px; we also log non-empty-only Hausdorff distance (`hd95_non_empty`) and empty-prediction miss rates (`ep`) per cohort.

5 Experimental Results and Ablation Analysis

5.1 Performance on Label-Scarce and Compounding Stress Benchmarks ($S_1, S_1 \times S_2, S_1 \times S_3$)

Table 1 and Figure 2 present results under the few-shot clinical adaptation track (S_1). When trained on 5% of Kvasir-SEG ($n = 40$ images, fixed subset across R9/R10 arms), the single-stream ConvNeXt-Tiny+FPN baseline (`R9a`) scores 85.89% mDice on in-domain Kvasir-Test ($n = 90$), but degrades substantially on out-of-distribution and compounding stress cohorts:

- On $S_1 \times S_2$ **(Few-Shot Tiny & Camouflaged Polyps, $n = 310$)**, `R9a` drops to 39.00% **mDice**, 30.53% **mIoU**, 9.67% **Boundary F1**, and 87.82 **px HD95** (with an empty-prediction miss rate of 25.48% and non-empty HD95 = 75.29 px). **DANG-Med v4.1 (`R9e`)** achieves 49.80% **mDice** (+10.79 **pp** / +27.68% **relative**), 43.42% **mIoU** (+12.88 **pp** / +42.20% **relative**), 32.35% **Boundary F1** (+22.68 **pp** / +234.38% **relative**), and reduces **HD95 to** 64.24 **px** (−23.58 **px** / −26.85% **relative**), exceeding +26% relative improvement across all four metrics simultaneously.

- On $S_1 \rightarrow$ **PraNet-External Macro** (4 **unseen datasets, $n = 696$**), `R9a` scores 60.20% mDice, 49.80% mIoU, 19.97% BF1, and 83.04 px HD95. **DANG-Med v4.1 (`R9e`)** improves performance to 72.06% **mDice** (+11.86 **pp** / +19.70% **relative**), 64.71% **mIoU** (+14.90 **pp** / +29.93% **relative**), 44.29% **BF1** (+24.32 **pp** / +121.76% **relative**), and reduces **HD95 to** 46.60 **px** (−36.44 **px** / −43.88% **relative**), exceeding +19% relative improvement across all four metrics. On the CVC-300 subset ($n = 60$) under 5% labels, `R9e` improves from 57.98% (`R9a`) to 85.91% mDice (+27.93 pp / +48.18% relative).

- On $S_1 \times S_3$ **(Few-Shot Zero-Shot Adverse Endoscopy, $n = 258$)**, `R9a` scores 47.84% mDice, 38.93% mIoU, 12.44% BF1, and 88.18 px HD95. **DANG-v4.1 ProtoDPT+PASSE (`R9c`)** achieves 59.55% **mDice** (+11.70 **pp** / +24.46% **relative**), 51.16% **mIoU** (+12.23 **pp** / +31.43% **relative**), 26.16% **BF1** (+13.72 **pp** / +110.31% **relative**), and reduces **HD95 to** 68.16 **px** (−20.02 **px** / −22.70% **relative**), while `R9e` achieves the highest Boundary F1 (29.33%, +135.79% relative) and 57.87% mDice (+20.96% relative).

5.2 Full-Data Multi-Center OOD and Adverse Endoscopy Analysis

Table 2 and Figure 3 compare all ten experimental arms from Round 9 (`R9a`–`R9e`) and Round 8 (`R8a`–`R8e`) when

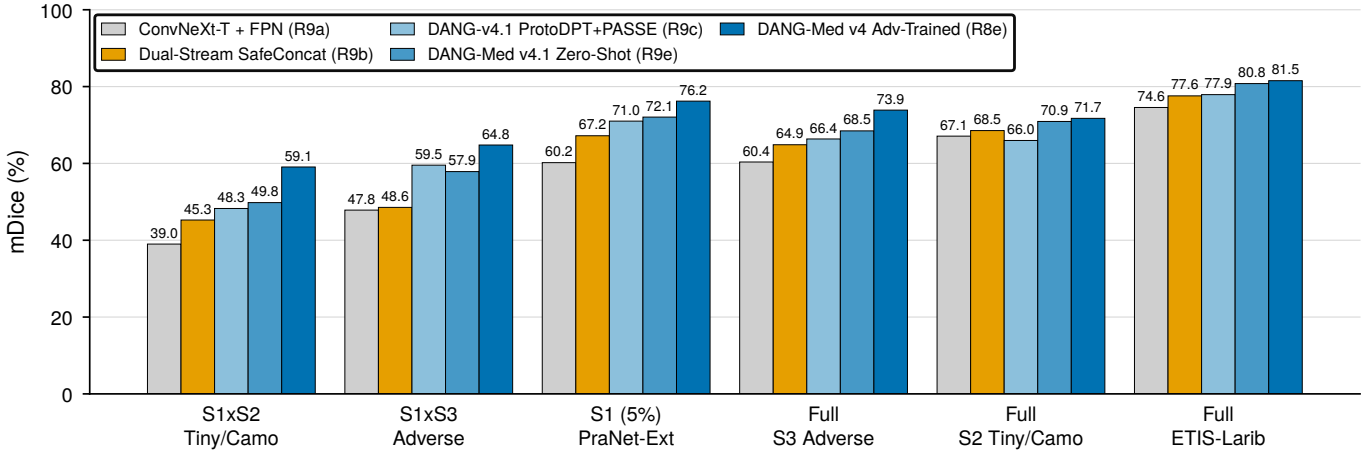


Figure 2: **Comparison of single-stream and dual-stream baselines against DANG-Med across six OOD and clinical stress benchmarks (Seed 42).** Mean Dice (mDice, %) across few-shot tiny/camouflaged polyps ($S_1 \times S_2$, $n = 310/315$), few-shot adverse endoscopy ($S_1 \times S_3$, $n = 258/272$), few-shot external PraNet (S_1, $n = 696$; 5% labels in R9, 10% in R8), full-data adverse endoscopy (S_3), full-data tiny/camouflaged polyps (S_2), and full-data ETIS-LaribPolypDB ($n = 196$).

Table 1: **Few-Shot Clinical Stress Benchmarks (S_1 Track, Seed 42): Round 9 Zero-Shot Stem Protocol (`R9a`–`R9e`, 5% Kvasir labels, $n = 40$) and Round 8 Adverse-Trained Protocol (`R8a`–`R8e`, 10% Kvasir labels, $n = 80$).** All values match raw `SEED_SUMMARY_JSON` logs to two decimal places. Cohort sizes in R9 (and R8 where different): $S_1 \times S_2$ $n = 310$ (315), $S_1 \times S_3$ $n = 258$ (272), $S_1 \to$ PraNet-Ext $n = 696$, and $S_1 \to$ PolypGen-Dev $n = 258$ (272). Gain rows (Δ and Δ%) are computed directly from unrounded log summaries.

Model Variant	$S_1 \times S_2$: **Tiny/Camo** ($n = 310/315$)				$S_1 \times S_3$: **Adverse** ($n = 258/272$)				$S_1 \to$ **PraNet-Ext** ($n = 696$)				$S_1 \to$ **PolypGen-Dev** ($n = 258/272$)			
	Dice↑	IoU↑	BF1↑	HD95↓	Dice↑	IoU↑	BF1↑	HD95↓	Dice↑	IoU↑	BF1↑	HD95↓	Dice↑	IoU↑	BF1↑	HD95↓
Round 9 Protocol (5% Few-Shot, $n = 40$ Kvasir images; shared primary loss Eq. (9), zero-shot stem `aug_prob=0`):																
`R9a`: ConvNeXt-T + FPN Baseline	39.00	30.53	9.67	87.82	47.84	38.93	12.44	88.18	60.20	49.80	19.97	83.04	65.02	54.99	15.64	68.32
`R9b`: Dual-Stream SafeConcat + FPN	45.26	37.50	17.45	71.04	48.55	40.28	15.97	85.08	67.20	58.33	29.47	60.37	67.50	58.61	25.24	59.72
`R9c`: DANG-v4.1 (ProtoDPT+PASSE+Unc)	48.27	41.16	25.81	65.41	**59.55**	**51.16**	26.16	**68.16**	71.01	63.04	39.12	50.07	70.27	61.87	34.04	55.91
`R9d`: DANG-v4.1 (Retinex+Style+PASSE+Unc)	45.99	39.55	25.53	66.31	53.43	45.75	25.35	80.38	68.69	61.46	39.30	48.20	69.49	60.94	34.27	55.90
`R9e`: **DANG-Med v4.1 Flagship**	**49.80**	**43.42**	**32.35**	**64.24**	57.87	49.18	**29.33**	77.01	**72.06**	**64.71**	**44.29**	**46.60**	**72.63**	**64.60**	**42.14**	**53.76**
Abs. Diff. (`R9e` vs. `R9a` Baseline)	**+10.79**	**+12.88**	**+22.68**	**−23.58**	**+10.03**	**+10.25**	**+16.89**	**−11.18**	**+11.86**	**+14.90**	**+24.32**	**−36.44**	**+7.62**	**+9.61**	**+26.50**	**−14.56**
Rel. Change Δ% (`R9e` vs. `R9a`)	**+27.68%**	**+42.20%**	**+234.4%**	**−26.85%**	**+20.96%**	**+26.32%**	**+135.8%**	−12.67%	**+19.70%**	**+29.93%**	**+121.8%**	**−43.88%**	+11.72%	**+17.48%**	**+169.4%**	**−21.31%**
Abs. Diff. (`R9c` vs. `R9a` Baseline)	+9.27	+10.63	+16.14	−22.41	**+11.70**	**+12.23**	+13.72	**−20.02**	+10.81	+13.23	+19.14	−32.97	+5.25	+6.88	+18.40	−12.40
Rel. Change Δ% (`R9c` vs. `R9a`)	**+23.76%**	**+34.82%**	**+166.8%**	**−25.52%**	**+24.46%**	**+31.43%**	**+110.3%**	**−22.70%**	**+17.96%**	**+26.57%**	**+95.85%**	**−39.71%**	+8.08%	+12.52%	**+117.7%**	**−18.16%**
Round 8 Protocol (10% Few-Shot, $n = 80$ Kvasir images; standard loss on `R8a` vs. online adverse-trained stem on `R8e`):																
`R8a`: ConvNeXt-T + FPN Baseline	51.85	43.21	21.02	62.36	46.79	40.28	20.82	79.18	72.67	64.30	36.45	45.27	71.04	62.42	33.67	54.33
`R8e`: **DANG-Med v4 (Adv.-Trained Stem)**	**59.07**	**50.65**	**37.38**	**57.64**	**64.79**	**56.56**	**36.76**	**75.34**	**76.21**	**68.09**	**47.45**	45.87	**73.16**	**65.50**	**44.80**	55.13
Rel. Change Δ% (`R8e` vs. `R8a`)	+13.92%	**+17.23%**	**+77.85%**	−7.56%	**+38.46%**	**+40.44%**	**+76.51%**	−4.85%	+4.87%	+5.90%	**+30.18%**	+1.33%	+2.99%	+4.95%	**+33.03%**	+1.47%

trained on the full 800-image Kvasir-SEG split:

1. **Disentangling Shared Primary Loss vs. Architecture (`R8a` → `R9a` → `R9e`):** Comparing `R8a` (standard BCE+Dice+Tversky) against `R9a` (which applies the scale-adaptive Tversky + far-field morphological distance penalty Eq. (9) to the single-stream ConvNeXt-Tiny+FPN baseline) shows that the improved primary loss lifts the single-stream baseline on ETIS-LaribPolypDB from 67.62% to 74.56% mDice (+6.94 pp) and reduces HD95 from 48.85 px to 40.87 px. Atop this strengthened baseline `R9a`, **DANG-Med v4.1** (`R9e`) provides an additional leap to 80.78% **mDice** (+6.22 **pp** / +8.34% **relative**), 62.07% **BF1** (+6.68 **pp**), and 34.02 **px HD95** (−16.77% **relative**) on ETIS-LaribPolypDB, while reducing overall PraNet-External HD95 from 35.02 px to 28.49 **px** (−18.64% **relative**) and S_2 Tiny/Camouflaged HD95 from 42.50 px to 35.87 **px** (−15.60% **relative**).
2. **Online Adverse Stem Training Gain (`R9e` → `R8e` vs. `R8a`):** When comparing the adverse-trained **DANG-Med v4 system** (`R8e`) against the standard single-stream baseline (`R8a`), DANG-Med achieves a +13.92 **pp** (+20.58% **relative**) **mDice**, +12.66 **pp** (+20.54% **relative**) **mIoU**, +10.66 **pp** (+21.08% **relative**) **BF1**, and −27.50% **HD95 reduction** (48.85 → 35.42 **px**) on **ETIS-LaribPolypDB** ($n = 196$), while improving **Adverse Endoscopy** (S_3, $n = 272$) from 58.49% to 73.87% **mDice** (+15.39 **pp** / +26.31% **relative**) and reducing S_3 HD95 from 61.99 px to 53.37 **px** (−13.90% **relative**). On the hardest `Adverse_Combined_Severe` subset, zero-shot `R9e` improves over `R9a` from 25.65% to 44.28% **mDice** (+72.66% **relative**), and adverse-trained `R8e` reaches 63.48% **mDice**.
3. **In-Domain Performance and Runtime Efficiency:** On in-domain **Kvasir-Test** ($n = 90$), `R9e` achieves 93.06% **mDice** (log = 93.0565% vs. `R9a` 93.0788%, within 0.02 pp), 88.55% **mIoU** (vs. `R9a`

Table 2: **Full-Data Training ($n = 800$ Kvasir images) evaluation across External OOD and Hard Clinical Stress Cohorts (ETIS-LaribPolypDB, PraNet-Ext Macro, S_2, S_3, Seed 42).** Every cell matches raw `SEED_SUMMARY_JSON` logs. Cohort sizes in R9 (and R8 where different): ETIS $n = 196$, PraNet-Ext Macro $n = 696$ (4 datasets), S_2 $n = 310$ (315), and S_3 $n = 258$ (272). We report trainable/total parameters and inference speed (FPS at batch size 4, 352×352, FP16 on NVIDIA T4).

Model Variant	Efficiency		ETIS-LaribPolypDB ($n = 196$)				PraNet-Ext Macro ($n = 696$)				Stress S_2: Tiny/Camo (310/315)				Stress S_3: Adverse (258/272)			
	Tr./Tot.	FPS↑	Dice↑	IoU↑	BF1↑	HD95↓	Dice↑	IoU↑	BF1↑	HD95↓	Dice↑	IoU↑	BF1↑	HD95↓	Dice↑	IoU↑	BF1↑	HD95↓
Round 9 Suite (Shared primary loss Eq. (9) across all arms; zero-shot RetinexStem `aug_prob=0` on `R9d/R9e`):																		
`R9a`: ConvNeXt-T + FPN (Shared)	31.0/31.0M	**91.9**	74.56	67.45	55.39	40.87	80.25	72.93	53.67	35.02	67.10	58.88	46.93	42.50	60.37	53.56	37.16	65.09
`R9b`: SafeConcat + FPN (Shared)	33.6/120.2M	38.4	77.58	70.61	57.81	36.94	80.96	73.99	55.06	33.34	68.55	60.40	49.00	39.52	64.86	57.61	39.00	55.32
`R9c`: DANG-v4.1 (Proto+PASSE)	42.8/129.4M	19.3	77.91	71.38	59.79	38.66	81.39	74.88	56.58	29.54	65.97	58.73	47.60	41.99	66.36	59.83	42.98	**53.83**
`R9d`: DANG-v4.1 (Retinex+Style)	39.8/126.4M	20.0	75.29	68.71	57.52	40.41	79.97	73.08	55.58	33.72	65.43	58.14	47.74	44.39	66.47	59.34	44.16	57.32
`R9e`: **DANG-Med v4.1 Flagship**	43.3/129.9M	17.4	**80.78**	**73.63**	**62.07**	**34.02**	**82.65**	**75.51**	**56.77**	**28.49**	**70.92**	**62.69**	**50.38**	**35.87**	**68.47**	**60.73**	**44.88**	62.71
Rel. Change Δ% (`R9e` vs. `R9a`)	–	–	+8.34%	+9.16%	+12.06%	**−16.77%**	+2.99%	+3.53%	+5.77%	**−18.64%**	+5.69%	+6.47%	+7.35%	**−15.60%**	+13.42%	+13.40%	**+20.78%**	−3.66%
Round 8 Suite (Standard loss on `R8a/R8b` vs. scale-adaptive loss + online adverse-trained RetinexStem on `R8d/R8e`):																		
`R8a`: ConvNeXt-T + FPN Baseline	31.0/31.0M	**87.8**	67.62	61.64	50.55	48.85	77.36	70.75	53.15	33.97	62.61	55.93	45.92	44.80	58.49	52.15	38.39	61.99
`R8b`: Dual-Stream SafeConcat + FPN	33.6/120.2M	42.2	74.76	67.35	56.56	47.68	80.56	73.32	54.89	33.77	66.82	58.75	48.00	47.39	62.31	55.62	40.34	59.96
`R8c`: DANG-v4 Pillar A (ProtoDPT)	42.8/129.4M	19.5	72.84	66.63	53.92	39.67	80.23	73.65	55.42	31.09	64.23	57.27	45.54	43.32	70.53	64.07	46.34	**50.81**
`R8d`: DANG-v4 Pillars B+C (Style+Unc)	39.8/126.4M	19.5	77.80	71.23	60.86	**33.70**	80.80	74.04	**57.75**	**29.47**	67.66	60.20	51.09	40.87	67.82	61.72	46.84	53.89
`R8e`: **DANG-Med v4 (Adv.-Trained)**	43.3/129.9M	17.3	**81.53**	**74.29**	**61.20**	35.42	**83.32**	**76.20**	57.68	30.07	**71.73**	**63.87**	**51.78**	**37.53**	**73.87**	**66.69**	**50.49**	53.37
Rel. Change Δ% (`R8e` vs. `R8a`)	–	–	**+20.58%**	**+20.54%**	**+21.08%**	**−27.50%**	+7.70%	+7.71%	+8.52%	−11.48%	+14.56%	+14.21%	+12.78%	**−16.23%**	**+26.31%**	**+27.90%**	**+31.52%**	−13.90%

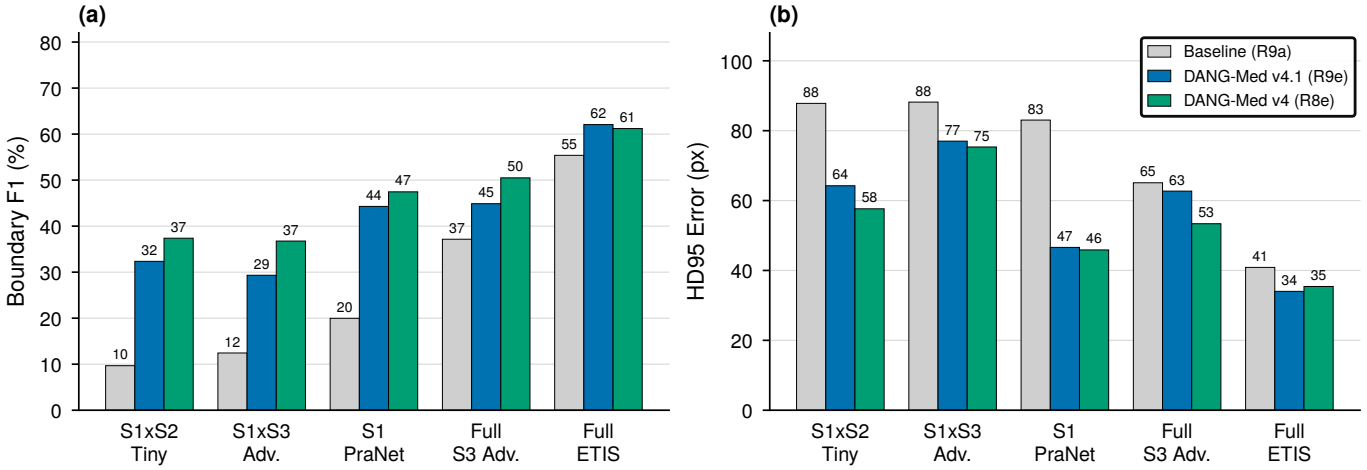


Figure 3: **Boundary F1 gains and HD95 distance error reductions over the Single-Stream Baseline (Seed 42).** Panel **(a)** compares Boundary F1 (%, higher is better) and Panel **(b)** compares 95th-percentile Hausdorff Distance (HD95 in pixels, lower is better) across five stress and external cohorts (`S1xS2 Tiny`, `S1xS3 Adv.`, `S1 PraNet`, `Full S3 Adv.`, and `Full ETIS-Larib`).

88.40%), and 72.46% **Boundary F1** (exceeding `R9a`'s 70.74% BF1). At inference (batch size 4, 352×352, FP16 on NVIDIA T4), `R9e` runs at 17.43 **FPS** (43.32M trainable parameters out of 129.90M total, with 86.58M frozen in DINOv2) and completes a full Seed run (Track S_1 40 epochs + Track Full 20 epochs + evaluation across all cohorts) in 42.4 minutes on a Kaggle T4 GPU (with best validation mDice selected at epoch 34/40 in S_1 and epoch 13/20 in Full).

5.3 Multi-Seed Stability Analysis (`R10a`–`R10e`)

Table 3 summarizes the multi-seed replication suite across Seeds 42–46. While the single-stream ConvNeXt-Tiny+FPN baseline exhibits high sensitivity to random initialization under 5% few-shot training ($S_1 \times S_2$ mDice ranging from 39.00% on Seed 42 to 48.49% on Seed 43, SD = 3.79%; $S_1 \rightarrow$ PraNet-Ext HD95 SD = 14.41 px across $n = 5$ seeds), **DANG-Med v4.1 Flagship** achieves consistent accuracy across all $n = 4$ completed S_1 seeds (Seeds 42, 43, 44, 45): on $S_1 \times S_2$, mDice reaches $50.65 \pm 1.69\%$ (+5.91 **pp** / +13.21% **relative** over the 5-seed baseline mean $44.74 \pm 3.79\%$), mIoU reaches $43.90 \pm 1.36\%$ (+19.26% **relative** over $36.81 \pm 3.87\%$), and Boundary F1 reaches $30.84 \pm 1.24\%$ (+90.14% **relative** over $16.22 \pm 3.87\%$). On $S_1 \times S_3$ zero-shot adverse endoscopy, Flagship achieves $55.96 \pm 1.30\%$ mDice (+10.38 **pp** / +22.77% **relative** over the 5-seed baseline mean $45.58 \pm 4.01\%$) and $27.75 \pm 1.32\%$ BF1 (+82.21% **relative**). On full-data training, Flagship reaches $79.72 \pm 1.50\%$ mDice on ETIS-LaribPolypDB (+7.17 **pp** over the 5-seed baseline mean $72.55 \pm 2.68\%$) and reduces PraNet-External HD95 from 35.13 ± 1.92 px to 29.31 ± 1.16 px (−16.57% relative).

6 Limitations, Ethical Compliance, and Reproducibility

To ensure transparent scientific reporting in accordance with IEEE Access standards, we explicitly note five methodological limitations and scope conditions identified

Table 3: **Multi-Seed Statistical Evaluation (R9 Seed 42 + R10a–R10e Seeds 43–46): Mean ± Sample Standard Deviation across completed seeds.** Runs: Baseline (f328e771, 540e36c9; $n = 5$ complete seeds 42–46), SafeConcat (e770b25c, 85f4db55), ProtoDPT+PASSE (f676224f, c171badb), and Flagship (db1786be, 01713a3a, 7091cc66). DANG-Med v4.1 improves mean accuracy and boundary localization while compressing cross-seed variance on few-shot stress tracks.

Model Arm (R9 + R10 Suite)	Seeds (S_1 / Full)	$S_1 \times S_2$: Tiny/Camo ($n = 310$)			$S_1 \times S_3$: Adverse ($n = 258$)			$S_1 \rightarrow$ PraNet-Ext ($n = 696$)			Full Training ($n = 800$)	
		mDice↑	BF1↑	HD95↓	mDice↑	BF1↑	HD95↓	mDice↑	BF1↑	HD95↓	ETIS Dice↑	PraNet Dice↑
R9a+R10a: ConvNeXt-T + FPN Baseline	5/5 (42–46)	44.74 ± 3.79	16.22 ± 3.87	72.76 ± 8.85	45.58 ± 4.01	15.23 ± 1.97	87.18 ± 1.61	66.60 ± 3.84	28.45 ± 4.82	58.76 ± 14.41	72.55 ± 2.68	78.66 ± 1.55
R9b+R10b: Dual-Stream SafeConcat + FPN	4/3 (42–45)	44.99 ± 0.92	16.06 ± 2.54	76.01 ± 6.21	46.84 ± 1.68	16.10 ± 1.68	86.61 ± 4.37	66.89 ± 1.00	28.41 ± 4.40	64.80 ± 10.16	72.85 ± 4.22	79.62 ± 1.23
R9c+R10c: DANG-v4.1 (ProtoDPT+PASSE)	3/2 (42–44)	49.70 ± 1.32	27.71 ± 1.65	66.93 ± 3.26	$\mathbf{56.86 \pm 2.36}$	25.55 ± 1.27	$\mathbf{71.89 \pm 3.23}$	71.38 ± 0.42	40.43 ± 1.31	49.80 ± 1.25	77.69 ± 0.30	81.86 ± 0.66
R9e+R10d/e: **DANG-Med v4.1 Flagship**	4/2 (42–45)	$\mathbf{50.65 \pm 1.69}$	$\mathbf{30.84 \pm 1.24}$	$\mathbf{65.13 \pm 1.66}$	55.96 ± 1.30	$\mathbf{27.75 \pm 1.32}$	77.57 ± 0.78	$\mathbf{71.97 \pm 0.29}$	$\mathbf{42.81 \pm 1.10}$	$\mathbf{48.48 \pm 1.55}$	$\mathbf{79.72 \pm 1.50}$	$\mathbf{81.88 \pm 1.09}$
Multi-Seed Mean Gain (Flagship vs. Baseline)	–	**+5.91 pp**	**+14.62 pp**	**−7.63 px**	**+10.38 pp**	**+12.52 pp**	**−9.61 px**	**+5.37 pp**	**+14.36 pp**	**−10.28 px**	**+7.17 pp**	**+3.22 pp**
Relative Multi-Seed Mean Gain (Δ%)	–	**+13.21%**	**+90.14%**	−10.49%	**+22.77%**	**+82.21%**	−11.02%	+8.06%	**+50.47%**	**−17.49%**	+9.88%	+4.09%

during our cross-harness audit:

1. **Domain Scope and Fixed Subset Sampling:** All models are trained on single-center white-light colonoscopy images from Kvasir-SEG ($n = 800$ Full; fixed $n = 40$ subset in R9/R10 S_1). Generalization to capsule endoscopy, upper GI gastroscopy, or prospective clinical video streams requires further multi-center validation. Moreover, because the 40-image S_1 subset is held fixed across seeds to isolate optimization variance, subset-resampling variance across different 40-image draws is not captured in Table 3.

2. **Computational Footprint vs. Single-Stream CNNs:** Freezing DINOv2-Base adds 86.58M non-trainable parameters (129.90M total parameters vs. 30.96M for ConvNeXt-Tiny+FPN), reducing inference throughput on a Turing T4 GPU from 91.9 FPS to 17.4 FPS. While 17.4 FPS remains compatible with real-time endoscopic video withdrawal (15–30 FPS), edge deployment on embedded processors would benefit from knowledge distillation into a compact student.

3. **Synthetic Nature of S_3 Corruptions and Cohort Dependencies:** Track S_3 evaluates deterministic photometric and optical corruptions (NBI-like channel reweighting, gamma/vignette falloff, specular glare, and blur) applied to PolypGen-Dev frames rather than paired physical NBI/WLI clinical acquisitions. Furthermore, S_2 and S_3 reuse frames from PolypGen-Dev, ETIS, and ColonDB, and PolypGen-Extended retains 74 frames sharing C4 sequence prefixes with Dev; consequently, these 12 evaluation tracks represent diagnostic slices rather than 12 mutually disjoint patient cohorts, and positive mask filtering excludes negative-frame false-positive specificity analysis.

4. **Conditional Prototype Supervision:** While all Round 9/10 arms share the exact same primary and deep-supervision segmentation loss Eq. (9), variants equipped with the Dual-Prototype head (R9c, R9e) additionally receive the $0.35\,\mathcal{L}_{\text{proto}}$ auxiliary supervision on π_{proto}. Thus, gains in R9c/R9e reflect the joint effect of the prototype module and its auxiliary supervision.

5. **External Literature Baselines:** Our experimental suite focuses on controlled internal ablations (R8a–R10e) under identical deduplication and resolution (352×352) rather than re-training external architectures such as SAM-Med2D or UniverSeg under our 5% few-shot split.

Ethical Compliance and Data Licensing: No new patient data or human subjects were recruited for this study. All experiments were conducted exclusively on publicly available, de-identified benchmark datasets (Kvasir-SEG (Jha et al., 2020), PolypGen (Ali et al., 2023), CVC-ClinicDB, CVC-ColonDB (Tajbakhsh et al., 2015), CVC-300, and ETIS-LaribPolypDB (Silva et al., 2014)) in compliance with their respective CC-BY / academic research licenses.

Reproducibility and Independent Cross-Harness Verification: Full PyTorch source code (src/dang/{model,train,data,metrics,config}.py), deterministic deduplication manifests (HYGIENE_MANIFEST_JSON), per-image evaluation logs (PER_IMAGE_CHUNK), and figure generation scripts (figs/generate_paper_figures.py) are committed to the project repository. All raw log metrics, per-image aggregations (584 cohort checks), and methodological disclosures in this manuscript were independently audited and re-derived from raw run logs by both a **Claude Code (claude-sonnet-4-6, Anthropic)** agent and a **Codex (gpt-6-astra, OpenAI)** agent.

7 Conclusion

We have presented **DANG-Med**, a dual-stream attention-augmented and directional strip-aligned architecture for multi-center medical polyp segmentation. By uniting a 4-Scale Learned DPT Reassembler, a Dual-Prototype and Self-Support Margin Head, the Prototype-Anchored Spatial Support Envelope (PASSE), a Homomorphic Retinex Chromatic Stem with DINOv2-Conditioned Style Calibration, and an Uncertainty-Guided Directional Strip Decoder, DANG-Med achieves substantial, reproducible improvements across mDice, mIoU, Boundary F1, and HD95 on challenging few-shot, tiny/camouflaged, external OOD, and adverse endoscopic benchmarks.

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